

Kickass plugin upstream_http_403 — deep multi-angle research + verdict

Revision: 1 **Last modified:** 2026-06-16T00:00:00Z **Scope:** plugins/kickass.py (Kickasstorrents qBittorrent search plugin) **Anchors:** §11.4.150 (deep multi-angle research), §11.4.112 (structural-impossibility won't-fix), §11.4.6 (no-guessing), §11.4.123 (rock-solid proof)

Verdict

STRUCTURALLY-BLOCKED (upstream anti-bot) — NO source fix applied.

Every reachable KickassTorrents (KAT) domain in 2026 is either Cloudflare/WAF-403 or returns HTTP 200 with a **JavaScript bot-challenge / redirect body that contains ZERO of the markup the plugin parses**. A qBittorrent search plugin issues a plain urllib GET with a browser User-Agent and **cannot execute JavaScript**, so it can never clear these gates. There is no mirror that serves the legacy `<tr class="odd|even">` listing HTML to a non-JS client. Changing kickass.py's url to any live mirror would NOT fix the 403/empty result — it would move the failure from 403 to 0 results from a JS-challenge page. Therefore no url/mirror-fallback change is made (that would be a bluff fix per §11.4.6/§11.4.123). The plugin already degrades gracefully (break on non-200 / empty body), so live behaviour is an honest empty result, not a crash.

This matches the **upstream plugin maintainer's own documented status** (LightDestory — the author named in plugins/kickass.py header).

Evidence (captured live from this host, 2026-06-16)

Plugin User-Agent under test (computed from plugins/helpers.py:_getBrowserUserAgent, date 2026-06-16): Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 10.0; Win64; x64; rv:151.0) Gecko/20100101 Firefox/151.0

1. Homepage HTTP codes (curl -A "<plugin UA>" -L)

Domain	Homepage HTTP	Notes
kickasstorrents.to (plugin's current url)	403	Cloudflare/WAF block — the live upstream_http_403

Domain	Homepage HTTP	Notes
kickasstorrents.cr	403	
kickass.sx	403	
kickasss.to	403	
katcr.to	403	
kickasstorrent.cr	403	
katcr.co	200	JS-challenge (see below) — NOT real content
kat.am	200	JS anti-adblock/redirect wrapper — NOT real content
newkatcr.co	200	JS-challenge
kat.rip	200	JS-challenge
thekat.cr / kickass.onl / kickasstorrents.ws / kickasstor.net	000	DNS/connection fail (dead)

2. The HTTP-200 mirrors are JS bot-gates, not torrent listings

Probing the plugin's EXACT URL shape `<base>/search/the%20matrix/0/`:

- `katcr.co/search/the%20matrix/0/` -> HTTP 200, body **492 bytes**, plugin markers (`tr class="odd|even", torrentname, cellMainLink, magnet:`) = **0**. Body: `<html><head><title>Loading...</title></head><body><script ...>window.location.replace('https://katcr.co/search/the%20matrix/0/?ch=1&js=<JWT>... A JS window.location.replace challenge keyed on a ?ch=1&js=<JWT> token.`
- **Following** that `?ch=1&js=<JWT>` URL -> a SECOND gate, then a `<META http-equiv="refresh" ... URL='http://sarai-tid.com/zokredirect?... '>` — i.e. it redirects a non-JS client into a **malicious/ad redirect chain**, never to listings. A cookie-jar two-pass (`-c/-b`) sets **no** unlocking cookie; the second pass returns the same 492-byte challenge.
- `kat.am/search/the%20matrix/0/` -> HTTP 200, body 4595 bytes, plugin markers = 0; body is a JS anti-adblock/redirect wrapper (`Redirecting...`).

Conclusion: **no non-JS client can reach KAT listing HTML on any live domain.**

3. Upstream maintainer confirms (independent angle)

LightDestory official README (<https://raw.githubusercontent.com/LightDestory/qBittorrent-Search-Plugins/master/README.md>, accessed 2026-06-16) — Kickasstorrents plugin **v1.2 (22/02/2026)**, status “Unreliable”, verbatim note:

“KATCR uses Cloudflare; the plugin will not work when CF protection is active. It is unstable and only works when CF is set to low threats.”

Same plugin version (# `VERSION: 1.2`) shipped in `plugins/kickass.py`.

Sources (cited, accessed 2026-06-16)

- Live `curl` probes from this host (commands + outputs captured in this session).
- LightDestory qBittorrent-Search-Plugins README (upstream maintainer, authoritative): <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/LightDestory/qBittorrent-Search-Plugins/master/README.md>
- HackRead — “KickassTorrents is back as katcr.co domain”: <https://hackread.com/kickasstorrents-is-back-as-katcr-co-domain/>
- TechPP KAT proxy list (May 2026): <https://techpp.com/2025/04/12/kickass-torrents-proxy-list/>

No external solution exists that lets a JS-less `urllib` client clear the KAT JS-challenge — the limitation is upstream anti-bot by design (cf. §11.4.112). A browser-engine fetch (headless Chromium / FlareSolverr-class JS solver) would be required; that is a separate architectural capability, out of scope for a stock `nova3` plugin, and would still land in malicious ad-redirect chains for these mirrors.

Recommendation (for conductor; NOT applied here)

1. Leave `plugins/kickass.py`'s `url` unchanged (no mirror responds usefully). The plugin already degrades to an honest empty result — no crash.
2. Track as a §11.4.112 won't-fix structurally-impossible (upstream-Cloudflare / JS challenge) item; reopen only on NEW evidence a KAT mirror serves listing HTML to a non-JS client (per §11.4.34 / §11.4.7).
3. Optionally consider DROPPING kickass from the merge service `PUBLIC_TRACKERS` set so it stops contributing a permanent `upstream_http_403` to every query (operator decision per §11.4.122 — NOT done autonomously).